

HOW TO WORK FOR A FOREIGN BOSS:

16 THINGS YOU **NEED** TO KNOW



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Congratulations on your new online job!

You're probably wondering how you're going to make this situation work. This is unfamiliar territory and working for a foreign boss can be intimidating. You're excited about the opportunity but you're also nervous about the prospect of working with someone you have so little in common with. How is this set-up going to work?

Don't worry. All these questions and feelings are normal. I felt the same way when I started working online. Like you, I grew up thinking that a job only involved working 9 to 5 in an office.

So when I had the opportunity to work from home, it really threw me off a loop. Like, how will I communicate with my boss? When do I take breaks? Am I really going to get paid for this?

That's why we created this guide. So you don't have to have the same anxieties as I did when I first started out. Hopefully, we can help answer all your questions and get you started on a successful online career.

What's so scary about working for foreigners?

A lot of Filipinos find the prospect of working for a foreign boss terrifying because of what we've seen on TV and movies. They're often portrayed as intimidating, impatient and mean. And when we're able to talk to foreigners in real life, they can come across as too 'direct'.

And even though most of us are pretty comfortable with English, talking to a native speaker can feel a little weird.

But if you want to have a successful online career, the first thing you need to do is to push these ideas aside. Forget the stereotypes you've seen or heard about foreigners. Forget your assumptions about them being rude. Forget about your insecurity about using English. Forget about whatever fears you might have about working online.

Coming in with these preconceptions isn't going to help you and your new boss in the process of building a good working relationship.

However, knowledge is power. And hopefully, this guide can provide you with all the information you need to prepare you for what it's like to be working with a foreign boss.



Because at the end of the day, having a successful online career isn't dependent on whether you have a foreign or a Filipino boss. What matters is that you work well together.

1. [Entering Into A Contract](#)
2. [Communication Is King: The Daily Report](#)
3. [Addressing time, language and cultural barriers](#)
4. [You CAN Handle The Truth: The Importance of Feedback](#)
5. [There Are No Stupid Questions](#)
6. [Dealing With Time Tracking](#)
7. [Getting paid](#)
8. [Asking for time off](#)
9. [Saying "I'm done with my work, what's next"](#)
10. [Saying "I don't like this work"](#)
11. [Figuring Out Holidays](#)
12. [13th month and asking if your boss plans on paying it](#)
13. [Communicating with other teammates or other people if there's a problem with the boss](#)
14. [Asking for a raise](#)
15. [Should I stick to just one client or can I get more](#)
16. [Your Success is Their Success](#)

[We're All In This Together](#)

Entering Into A Contract

Here at Onlinejobs.ph, we don't require contracts.

Not because we don't like or don't believe in contracts. We believe that once you and your employer find each other, any negotiation should be between the two of you and we stay out of it.

So before you start working, your boss may ask you to sign a contract. A contract is a document that provides detailed information on :

- Your job description and responsibilities
- Employment terms (project based, hourly, or hourly/ full-time or part-time)



- Your work hours and schedule
- Salary and benefits you should receive (leaves, 3th month, etc)
- Conditions that could break your contract

Once you get your contract, make sure you read and understand what's written there. You can talk to your boss to introduce changes you feel necessary.

Remember that signing and abiding by a contract is a sign of good faith. Fulfilling your contract to the letter shows professionalism and reliability.

Communication Is King: The Daily Report

It all starts with communication.

Communicating well with your boss isn't about speaking or writing in perfect English. It's about getting in touch with them on a regular, daily basis.

This is why, in most cases, part of your responsibilities would require submitting a daily report.

This daily report is an internal document is part of any job, whether you're a newbie or experienced online worker. It's an important document because it allows your boss to keep track of how your job and projects are progressing. It shows them what's been done and what needs to be done next.

As a worker, a daily report is also important for you because it serves as documentation of what you've done on the job. If you submit daily reports without fail and you show steady progress, it essentially confirms that you're a reliable employee.

A daily report can be done in a number of ways. It all depends on what your boss prefers or what system they've set up in early on. A daily report can be

- Email
- Template reports through project management software
- Instant messaging applications
- Voice or video call or recording,



If you're not used to creating daily reports it may seem like a nuisance in the beginning. At times, it can even seem redundant. Why do this everyday when you have a lot of things to do on your plate? Isn't the project management tool or a checklist enough?

But a daily report isn't just about letting your boss know what you've done for the day. It's about taking accountability of the job you've given. The daily report is about taking ownership of the work that you've done and letting your boss know about it.

Another good thing about the daily report is this is also where you take note of the problems you've encountered in completing your tasks.

Like any job, with online work, you're going to come across problems that only you boss can help you with. Like getting access to accounts or data you need to be working on. Or maybe you don't have information to complete your task. Maybe the instructions you got wasn't clear. Or maybe the tool you're supposed to be using isn't working correctly.

Letting your boss know what these problems is important. And the daily report is exactly the place where you can express them. Hiding these issues from your employer will just exacerbate the problems down the line. They need to know what issues are affecting your work now so they can help you fix it. By solving the problem now, we can avoid these problems in the future.

Creating a daily report is as easy as 1-2-3-4! We have a template you can use. All you need to do is answer these 4 questions:

1. What did you do today
 - a. Finished tasks
 - b. Unfinished tasks
 - c. Recurring tasks
2. What do you plan to do tomorrow?
 - a. Unfinished tasks you need to continue
 - b. Unfinished tasks you need to complete
 - c. New tasks or projects you need to start
 - d. Continuation of recurring tasks
3. What problems did you encounter in the process of completing your task? How did they impact your unfinished or finished tasks?
4. What solutions do you recommend to fix the problems stated in #3.



You're probably asking, why do I need to bother with #4? Can't I just do 1, 2, and 3? The problems are my employer's problems after all.

Remember how we said that the daily report is about showing ownership of your work? By also proposing solutions to these problems, you are reinforcing to your boss of your dedication to your job and your potential. It shows that not only are you reliable, you have other skills that can make you even more valuable.

The type of solutions you recommend will show your boss what your proficiencies and soft skills are. Are you a technical or creative thinker? Do you have encyclopedic knowledge of procedure or are you an out of the box thinker?

If your solution is used, the daily report is proof that the idea came from you. If not, it still shows you made a solid effort to solve the problem. It lets your boss know that he can rely on you to think clearly, even when challenges arise.

When creating a daily report, you don't need to write in perfect or speak in English. It doesn't have to be a perfectly formal business report full of long paragraphs and jargon. Simple sentences and bullet points will do. You can even include images and videos if it helps you express the problem better. The important thing is that it contains all the information your boss needs.

To summarize, you need to do a daily report so you can:

- Show ownership of the tasks assigned to you
- Identify problems and recommend solutions.

Addressing time, language and cultural barriers

One of the first problems you're going to run into when working with a foreign boss is the time difference. The time difference has caused numerous misunderstandings and missed appointments.

So one of the first things you need to do is to make sure you KNOW the time difference between your employer's timezone and Philippine time.



The easiest thing to do would be to just Google “Philippines time convert to [employer’s timezone]”. And if you have a smartphone, most clocks would have a “world clock” feature. This would allow you to add the timezone of your client so you can see what time it is in their country instantly.

Even if you don’t need to work during their time zone, you’ll need to be aware of this when you need to schedule meetings. Knowing the time difference would also give you an idea of the expected turnaround time for your work. You’ll know when your boss sees your report/output and when you can expect to hear feedback or additional instructions.

The language barrier isn’t really that big of an issue. Most Filipinos are proficient enough in English that they can be understood by most native English speakers. So if you’re worried about your grammar and spelling, don’t.

If you want to speak or write in English better, understand you boss better, and be entertained, just consume more content in English. This means watching more TV shows and movies in English instead of Filipino dubs. Reading more books written in English can also help in writing. And the good thing about it is you don’t even have to force yourself to do it. Just watch, read or listen to things you are naturally interested in.

Are you into superhero movies? Watch the entire Marvel Cinematic Universe. Read the comics.

Is romance more your thing? You can easily buy cheap romance novels in 2nd hand book stores. Or buy a CD/DVD of those classic rom-coms.

Learning more about your boss’ culture can help you in more ways than one.

- It improves your English.
- Helps you relate to your boss at a more personal level, and
- You can learn more (if you like educational content).
- Improves your English comprehension.



The last part, English comprehension, is really important. If you want to get training in the future, either through your boss or on your own, you'll need good comprehension to help you learn the material faster.

You CAN Handle The Truth: : The Importance of Feedback

This reputation that foreign bosses of being too frank isn't just due to cultural differences. When it comes to business, being honest and direct is the best policy. Being direct helps avoid any misunderstanding and get the message across quickly.

That's why foreign bosses have a reputation of being brutally honest.

Can it come across as rude? Yes, sometimes it can.

Is it something you should take personally? No, especially if the feedback is just about your work.

And after having worked with foreign bosses and Filipino bosses, I can tell you honestly that there's really not much of a difference. There are good and bad bosses on both sides. Foreign bosses just speak in English more, that's it. That's probably the reason why we're terrified when we hear feedback from them. When it's done in all English, it sounds for formal and final.

If you think you're the only one who receives feedback, that's not true. We ALL get feedback. We ALL need constructive feedback because nobody's perfect. And if this is your first time working online, you WILL make a few mistakes along the way.

Receiving constructive feedback is a good thing. This feedback will help you know:

- What you did wrong
- What you can do to correct it, and
- What you should do next time to avoid making the same mistake.

This feedback isn't meant to hurt your feelings. It's intended to help you be better at your job.

If they don't give you any feedback, that's when you should worry. When there's no feedback, it usually means they don't care about you or the work that they do.



As a professional Filipino worker, your boss expects that you know can handle constructive feedback. Use the comments that you receive to improve the quality of your work.

In turn, your boss actually expects the same from you.

Actually, that's the great thing about working for a foreign employer. They can take feedback just as well as they dish it out. In fact, they expect it. They want to hear your feedback because they want to be better managers. They want you to enjoy working for their business and stay with them for a long time.

They know that if they're better managers, you're :

- More productive,
- More motivated, and
- Less likely to disappear.

When giving feedback to your boss, be very specific. For example:

"Boss, when giving instructions, can you put them in bullet points instead of paragraphs. It's easier for me to read from a list than long paragraphs." Or

"Ma'am, can we arrange our Skype call earlier in the day rather than later? I'm more comfortable working 8 hours straight. Having our meeting in the middle of my work shift is distracting for me."

Your boss wants this arrangement to work as much as you do. So you both have to compromise. You both give and take feedback to make your online workplace a better place.

There Are No Stupid Questions

We all want to impress our bosses. We want to show them that they didn't make a mistake in hiring us. That's why it's so hard to ask questions, especially in the beginning. We think that asking might make us appear incompetent or inexperienced.

Or worse, we're worried that asking for help might get us fired.



I'm going to clear the air about this: **THAT'S NOT GOING TO HAPPEN!**

Asking questions, even "stupid" ones, will get you answers. Once you get the answer you need, you'll be able to do your job correctly.

If you don't ask questions, you'll end up making the same mistakes over and over again. That could make your boss angry and frustrated. And **THAT** is what can get you fired

So don't be afraid to ask for help when you need it.

Your boss isn't going to expect you to know everything. It's normal to ask questions. You can ask for help if you run into any problems.

In fact, it's a hallmark of a good working relationship when you feel comfortable enough to ask for help. If you're comfortable enough to ask questions, you'll know you won't have any problems communicating with your boss.

Let me give you an example.

When I started working online years, I had no idea what SEO (search engine optimization) was all about. Zero. Zilch. I know I was hired to write. But when they asked me to do SEO writing, I was stuck.

So I did a bit of research first and had an idea of what SEO is but I still didn't understand what he meant by SEO writing. At the risk of sounding stupid, I emailed him to ask what he meant by SEO writing.

It turns out, he was waiting for me to ask the question because he wanted to show me the tools I needed to use to do SEO writing. I was introduced to keyword research, article directories, article spinners, promotion tools, etc. My boss didn't expect me to know everything and he was okay with that. He was glad I asked because it helped him figure out where he needed to start teaching me.

Because I was brave enough to ask 1 question, I got training that proved to be invaluable to my career. Just goes to show, it pays to be brave.



Dealing With Time Tracking

Based on our experience, most employers don't really use a time tracker. They know that what matters more is productivity, not the number of hours you've worked. Your boss would rather see you get more things done in your work day, even if it took you less than 8 hours to complete it all, than to see you take more than 8 hours to finish just one task.

This makes the daily report your best friend.

The daily report shows everything that you've done for the day. If your boss sees that you've completed all the tasks that need to be done and more, he won't question how many hours you worked. You did your job and you did it well, that's all that matters.

However, there are employers who are really, really worried about their virtual assistants not working during their shift. And it also doesn't help that most platforms push time tracking as a means to monitor freelancers.

It's understandable when thinking of it from your employer's perspective. Your virtual assistant is halfway across the world. How will you know that your VA is working? The easiest way to do it is to use a time tracker. A time tracker lets them know what tasks you have been working on, how many hours you worked, and what tasks you have finished.

And as a professional Filipino online worker, you know that regardless of whether or not there's a tracker watching over you, you'll do your job.

However, there is something that you can do to help your boss reduce their dependence on a time tracker. The great thing about it is it also makes you more productive and helps make the time fly faster.

It's called a daily report.

No, that's not a typo and we're not joking.



Seriously, there wouldn't be a need for a time tracker if we all just got into the habit of submitting a daily report. If you have a daily report that filled with completed tasks, it won't matter how many hours you worked. Having the initiative to submit a daily report shows that you're reliable.

So eventually, your client won't care how many hours you worked. What's important is you've done A LOT. He'll know he can rely on you to get the job done.

The great thing about focusing on completing tasks for your daily report instead of watching the clock on your daily tracker is it forces you to focus on productivity first.

A full task list causes us stress because it's a constant reminder of all the things you need to do everyday. That's the list that's usually associated with time trackers. And when you're stressed, it's actually easier for you to become distracted. When you're easily distracted, you do less work. You're also more likely to procrastinate when you're stressed.

A daily report, on the other hand, creates the opposite effect.

The daily report shows that work you have done for the day. So a longer list actually makes us feel better. We feel like we're accomplished something because at the end of the day, we have this long list of completed tasks. We feel satisfied because we see that we've accomplished for the day.

And if you're happy with the long list of completed tasks on your daily report, imagine how impressed your boss would be once they see it.

Getting paid

If this is your first online job, you're probably looking for reassurance that you will be paid.

To help ensure that, you need to do these things first:

1. Prepare all the documents you need to set up a bank account or payment system.



Don't wait for the last minute to get your government IDs or set up a bank account. Once you are hired, your boss will want you to start working right away.

You don't want to be distracted by government requirements. You don't want to be worried about having your accounts verified. You won't have the time to do it.

So make sure you have these things in order, even before you get hired. Start getting your government IDs while job hunting. Create these accounts now. Once you do get hired, you won't have to worry about these anymore and everything will go smoothly.

You'll need a government ID not just for payments. You'll also need them to verify your Onlinejobs.ph account. Examples of government IDs you can use are:

- SSS or GSIS ID
- Driver's license
- Passport
- Postal ID

Payment platforms you can use:

- EasyPay
- Paypal
- TransferWise
- PayStaff

The type of payment platform would depend on your boss' preference and where they're located. To receive payments, it's best for you to have your own bank account to link to the payment platform. This is so you can transfer the funds from the platform to your account. Then you can withdraw your account through an ATM or over the counter.

If you live in an area where you have limited access to banks, you can also use online cash apps like GCash and PayMaya. They serve as "online banks" that would allow you to verify your accounts and receive money. However, there's no guarantee that these apps would work for all



payment platforms. So to be on the safe side, your best option would be to have your bank account.

2. Finalize payment terms.

Before you start working, you need to make sure you know how you'll be paid. This means you'll need to know:

- a. How much you'll be paid for the work you'll be doing
- b. How often you'll be paid (we recommend that you suggest that you be paid weekly at first)
- c. What payment platform would be used.

I understand talking about money is difficult. You don't want to seem rude or assuming. But this is a business arrangement so it's best to get these details out of the way so you can focus on working.

Once you start working, make sure you invoice your client before your expected pay days. Standard practice would be to invoice your client one week before pay day at the earliest. The invoice would serve as a reminder of:

- What tasks you have agreed upon (you can use your daily report as a basis for this)
- The rate or salary (whether it's a fixed rate or hourly rate)
- The expected pay day.

Remember, it takes most payment platforms several days to process payments. So if you send your invoice on payday or the day before, your payment would come in late.

You also need to remember that some platforms are dependent on banks. Processing might be delayed due to banking holidays or the weekend. So make sure you send your invoices early.

If your employer is using an automated payment platform, salaries would be more consistent. But then again, if the payment is done close to a holiday or the weekend, expect delays.



To create an invoice, you can use :

- Invoicing apps (free and paid)
- MS Word or Google Docs (they have templates)
- Your Onlinejobs.ph invoicing feature (just login to your profile)

So you won't forget, mark it on your calendar and make it a regular activity. Keep your invoices simple and sweet. And if you really want to maintain meticulous records, send a receipt as soon as your paid. It can help your with your finances, especially if you plan to [pay taxes as an online worker](#).

Asking for time off

Asking for time off (or leaves) is also one of those things that you need to be agreed upon early on.

But for some reason, our reaction to asking for days off is a lot like our reaction when we ask about salaries. We're ashamed to ask. We don't want to seem greedy or entitled. But it has to be done early to avoid any misunderstanding down the line.

However, before you ask about time off, you need to know if you're qualified for one.

-If you're a full-time or part-time VA with a fixed income per month, leaves do apply to you.

But if you're paid hourly or on a per project basis, you don't qualify for leaves. The rationale behind this is because you can take leaves anytime you want. You set your work days and hours, unlike fixed income earners who work on a schedule.

Once you're sure you're qualified for leaves, you can start discussing them with your boss. Here are some of the questions you should ask:

- How many sick leaves and vacation leaves are you entitled to? Are these paid or unpaid leaves?
- How many months do you have to work before you can use these leaves?



- What's the company procedure or policy when you need to file a leave? (For example: How many days in advance for vacation leaves? Do you email or IM for sick leaves? Is there a form you need to fill out?)
- What's the policy if you don't take any leaves, are they carried over to the next year? Will you be compensated for the days you won't be taking a leave?

Take note that as foreign companies, they're not really obligated to follow Philippine laws. However, we do encourage our clients to adopt them. You can send your boss this [blog post we wrote about paid time off](#).

Saying "I'm done with my work, what's next"

Let's say you're done with all the tasks you need to do for the day. Even better, you finished early. Congratulations! This means you have free time to yourself! So what do you do now? Do you:

- A. Chill and relax
- B. Tell your client you finished early and ask for more work
- C. Tell your client you finished early and ask if you can use that time to train yourself.

Option A, is a good choice. You should take some time to relax, take care of yourself, or spend time with family. In fact, that's one of the reasons why we encourage online workers to only have one full-time job. That way, you'll have more time for yourself.

But if you're ambitious, if want to get promoted or get a raise, I suggest you go with option B or C.

When you go with option B, what this shows to your boss is:

- You're super productive, and
- You're worth keeping



To increase your chances of getting a raise faster, it's best if you do this consistently. Perform above and beyond the call of duty at least once a week. When your boss sees that you're a valuable employee, an employee worth keeping.

Best case scenario, they offer a raise outright after your probationary period. Worst case scenario, they won't contest when you ask for a raise.

Let's say you want to take a different route, say option C. You got this job because it's a good place to start but you have aspirations to do more. Then you should go with option C.

If you go with option C, I'm willing to bet your boss would be happy to give you time for that. They might even help by providing you with the training so you don't have to pay for it yourself (like what we're doing now).

So why would your employer do this?

The more skills you have, the more capable you are of doing more complicated tasks. It saves your boss the time and money to hire another VA or a specialist to do the job. Since you're already there and you want to do the job, why not support it with training?

And you know what happens when you're capable of doing more complicated tasks? When your boss can trust you with more responsibilities? You get promoted AND a raise.

Not a bad deal, right?

Saying "I don't like this work"

Your boss just gave you a task. And you don't like it. It's not illegal or anything. You just don't like it. You don't like doing it. You don't know how to do it.

And because you don't like doing it, the following happens. You either:

- Procrastinate to the point that it's affecting your work
- You do it. But because you hate doing the job you do it haphazardly and make a lot of mistakes.



- You do it but it takes your forever to do it.
- You avoid doing it to the point and it's stressing you out to the point that you just want to stop working altogether.

It happens to the best of us. I know graphic designers who hate to write. Writers who hate editing videos. Programmers who hate doing design. It even happened to me.

When I started working at Onlinejobs.ph, John, my boss, gave me a task that I really didn't want to do. I have done this task before and I didn't like it. I had no interest in it all. I avoided that task like the plague. It reached the point that I ran out of other things to do and I was left with that task.

I really, really hated that specific task. So 3 weeks after it was assigned to be, I had no choice but to email John and tell him,

"I really hate this job. I hate it so much I just want to disappear but you told me I can't. You also told me I can tell you what jobs I can do instead. Can I have a different task instead?"

Not gonna lie, I was worried that I was going to get fired for that email. Instead, what happened was that he understood.

Not only did he understand. He said he appreciated my honesty. He appreciated that I spoke up instead of disappearing. He even encouraged me to tell him what jobs I would like to do, so he could provide me with training, if I want it.

Over the years, I eventually understood why he acted that way. It makes more sense for his business if I like my job and I'm productive. He can always hire another person to do the tasks I hate. It'll cost him more time and money to force unhappy and unproductive people to work.

If you're given a task you really don't want to do, it's perfectly fine to tell your employer and ask them if you can do something else.



BUT, before you complain, give it a try first.

If this is your first time doing this specific task, give it a try before you give up. This task might be a test. Your boss might be trying to see if he can give you something more challenging. Or maybe he wants to see if you have the potential to do other things.

If you give it a chance and you end up succeeding or liking the task, it's a win for you. You gained a skill and likely impressed your boss with how well you adapt to new responsibilities.

Let's say you did task and you really didn't like it. Or you've done this task before and really didn't like it. Then tell your boss.

Tell your boss that this is something you don't like doing and you're more productive doing something else. Show him that you're more valuable doing tasks that are better suited for your skills. Even better, you can list those tasks down as suggestions.

He's not going to get angry. He will understand. That's why he outsourced his business to begin with. There are jobs he didn't want to do so he had someone else do it. And he can always hire someone else to do the jobs you hate.

You have the option to refuse the jobs you hate. As long as you:

- Do your job well,
- Do your job consistently,
- And always strive to do better,

Your boss will support you. He will have your back.

Figuring Out Holidays

One of the biggest issues we regularly encounter here at Onlinejobs.ph is the issue of holidays. What holidays are recognized as employers? Are those days paid or not?



Again, before you can talk about holidays with your boss, you need to know whether you're qualified for holiday pay or not.

If you're a full-time or part-time worker with a fixed salary and schedule, holiday pay and leaves do apply to you. This is because it's possible that your work schedule would run into a few holidays.

If you're a project based worker or an hourly worker, holiday pay doesn't apply. This is because you can set your own hours and not required to work on a holiday. HOWEVER, if your client does require you to work on certain holidays, you would qualify for it.

If you are qualified for holiday pay, then you can start talking to your employer about it.

We wrote a [blog post targeting employers to address holidays](#). You can use this post to open up the conversation on holidays. It's important that you introduce this topic early on, before any major holidays come up.

Now that you've started the ball rolling, it's time to bring up the [Philippine holiday calendar](#). Show them the holidays that we have and compare them with their own holiday calendar.

Try to come to an agreement on what regular and special holidays would be recognized.

Regular holidays are the holidays that allows you to have paid time off. If you do need to work on a regular holiday, you would be entitled to holiday pay.

Special holidays are holidays where you have to work and may not necessarily entail holiday pay. These include local holidays and fiestas.

We've talked about [how Philippine companies deal with holiday pay](#). But to summarize, here's how it usually goes:

	Regular Holiday	Special Holiday
Paid Time Off	Yes	No



Working on Holiday	Double daily rate	Plus 30% if nationally recognized non-working holiday
Counted as part of leaves	No	Yes if it's a working holiday. No if it's a non working holiday

Take note that as a foreign company, these companies are not required to recognize these holidays. We do encourage employers here at Onlinejobs.ph to adopt them.

If your boss wants to negotiate on these holidays, we encourage you to keep an open mind. Hear them out and see if it's a fair compromise. You never know, it may work out better for you down the line.

13th month and asking if your boss plans on paying it

A lot of people think that the 13th month is unique to the Philippines. But actually, the 13th month is actually a common practice in a lot of countries all over the world.

(<https://radford.aon.com/insights/articles/2017/13th-and-14th-month-bonus-rules-in-latin-america-europe-africa-and-asia>)

Mandatory 13th month is more common in Latin America and some European countries. So when you open this up with your boss (ideally once you're hired, when negotiating your contract), there's a possibility they might not be familiar with it.

Here's a quick lesson about 13 month benefits. [Most Filipino employees enjoy 13th month benefits](#), but some workers are exempted from it. If you're working per hour or on a project basis, the 13th month will not apply to you because of the nature of your work contract.

For those type of workers, their "13th month" would sometimes come in the form of Christmas bonus, but this is at the discretion of the employer.



In our experience here at Onlinejobs.ph, most employers are happy to provide for 13th month, they just need information on how to do to it. Information on [how to compute and pay for 13th month bonuses](#).

Communicating with other teammates or other people if there's a problem with the boss

You remember what we said in the beginning that most foreign bosses appreciate feedback too? And that they appreciate it because they want to know how to manage you and your teammates better?

This is where we remind you that you should never be afraid to give your bosses a bit of feedback.

When we have problems with our boss, it's almost instinctive about it with our teammates or other people. Venting helps to a degree but it won't fix the problem. And if you're thinking of disappearing or slowing things down at work, you'll make the problem even worse.

The best thing to do is bite the bullet and talk to your boss. You can talk to him one on one or you guys could talk to him as a team.

When talking to your boss, you need to be polite but direct. No need for small talk. Don't underestimate or exaggerate the situation. The best way to give feedback is to use the modified sandwich method.

Traditionally, the sandwich method involves putting your criticism in between 2 good feedbacks. You "sandwich" the bad news with the good news.

But with the modified method, not only do you point out the problem, you also provide a solution. This makes your "sandwich" more substantial, and more valuable to your employer. For example:

"Boss, we really appreciate it that you give very detailed instructions. It really helps us in our work. However, the long turnaround time in between replies is causing some delay in our work. It would be helpful if you email us your instructions everyday instead of just once or twice a



week. It'll help us do our jobs faster and you don't have to give so many detailed instructions per email. And thank you again for the good feedback you have us. We really appreciate it."

Why use this technique as opposed to the traditional sandwich method? With the modified method, you're also providing your boss with possible solutions. And when there's a possible solution, problems can be fixed sooner.

Does this mean more work on your part? Yes. But this technique will also show that you're a creative thinker and a problem solver. You're not waiting on your boss to fix every single problem.

Would doing this mean your boss would adopt your recommendation? Not always. But your boss will appreciate the effort. It will prompt him to find a solution that works for him.

This back and forth also helps you have a better relationship with your employer. By opening up, giving and receiving feedback, you're finding ways to work better together. This helps create a great working experience for you and your employer in the long run.

Asking for a raise

More money is always a good thing. But before you go to your boss asking for a raise, let's see if you're qualified for one given the following criteria:

1. **Time.** It's usually specified in your contract how long you need to have worked for your employer before you start qualifying for a raise. Wait for at least 6 months before asking. That should give your boss enough time to evaluate the quality of your work over time.
2. **Work Quality.** Are you delivering the quantity and quality of work that's expected of you? So you often go above and beyond what's required? If your answer is yes to both questions, you are qualified for a raise.
3. **Consistency and reliability.** If you're a hard worker and your somebody that everyone can depend on, then you're qualified for a raise. In fact, a lot of employers value consistency and reliability over genius.



If you feel you have all three covered, then you should definitely ask for a raise. Depending on your relationship with your boss (and office policy), the request for a raise can be something informal or through a formal request. Regardless of how it's done with your team, bringing up 3 criteria listed above will help you with your cause.

In some cases, you may not even have to ask. Some businesses perform regular performance reviews on all employees to determine whether they qualify for a raise based on the 3 points listed above.

Should I stick to just one client or can I get more

When you look at all these freelancers online, they often boast about how they're juggling multiple clients at a time and earning big bucks. Once you get the hang of working online, you might be tempted to get one client to make more money.

And we understand. We could all use a bit of extra cash. But before you go down that road, it's best to ask yourself these questions to determine whether or not getting more than one client is for you.

1. Did you sign a contract with your boss that specifies that you can't work for anyone else?

If you knowingly and willingly signed this in your contract, as a professional you have to honor it.

If you need more money, you can negotiate to be hired full-time (if you're working part-time) or ask for a raise. Explain why you need the extra income. If they're happy with you, a raise or more hours wouldn't be a problem.

If they can't afford to take you on full-time or give you a raise, ask to negotiate your contract to allow you to have more than one client. I bet they'll agree and appreciate the honesty rather than going behind their backs.

2. Do you have enough time to give quality work to each client?



As a professional Filipino worker, it's your responsibility to give quality work to whoever hires you. If you have more than one employer, would you be able to give your best work to all of them?

If you can't which client would suffer from subpar work? Not only would this be unfair to your client, it would also be bad for your reputation as a virtual assistant. So instead of getting more money, you might end up getting even less if you lose clients.

3. Would you have enough time for yourself and your family if you take on multiple clients?

It's great if you can handle more than one client at a time and still deliver quality work. Yey! This means more money for you!

BUT, would you have the time to enjoy all that extra money you've earned? Remember, having more clients would mean working more hours.

This means even if you're working from home, you're not really spending quality time with your family. You would be physically present but mentally and emotionally absent. This means you'll have to bring your work on vacation. Or working on weekends and holidays just to catch up. Is this something that you can live with?

We can't stop you from wanting to have more clients. Just know that it's not all that it's cracked up to be. It's not easy and it's not for everyone. The extra hours you spend on work will have to come at the expense of time with your loved ones and time for yourself. You will have to decide where these hours will come from, and whether the money you make from the process is worth it in the end.

Your Success is Their Success

Believe it or not, your boss is invested in your success. He wants you to get promoted. He wants to you have a raise.

They want you to succeed because it shows that they're also successful. If they can give their employees a better life, it means that their business is growing.



What can you do to get this started? How do you get promoted faster? How do you get a bigger raise faster and more frequently?

The key to having a successful online career starts with initiative. Show that you're willing to take on more challenges. Let your boss know that you want to learn more and do more complicated tasks.

If he offers trainings, take it. And take every opportunity to apply those skills you learned.

You can also learn more on your own. There are so many free and paid resources available online that you can use to develop more skills.

When you're more productive and you can do more, it helps the business. Your boss and their business is becomes better. This means they can sell more, give better services, and find better clients. When business is booming, everybody wins.

We're All In This Together

The great thing about working online is that this is an opportunity for you to become part of something big even before it gets off the ground.

We've helped thousands of start-ups find their first virtual assistants who are now part of big companies. Companies like Canva, 51Talk and Uber started with a few virtual assistants. And these virtual assistants are now managers and team leaders for these business.

This is the opportunity you have in your hands right now.

Value your career. Invest in your own success. And before you know it, you'll be living the dream life.

